

Subtracting on a Number Path

Counting back, counting up to find the difference, and finding a missing number.

- Each problem has its own number path. Put your finger on the start square, then hop.
- **Count back** to take away: hop one square to the *left* for each one you take away. The square you land on is the answer.
- **Count up** when the two numbers are close: start at the smaller number and hop *right* until you reach the bigger one. Count your hops.
- Draw your hops on the path, then write the answer on the line.

1. $6 - 2 =$ _____

Start on 6 and hop back 2 squares.

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
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2. $8 - 3 =$ _____

Start on 8 and hop back 3 squares.

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
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3. $10 - 4 = \underline{\hspace{2cm}}$

Start on 10 and hop back 4 squares.

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
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4. $9 - 7 = \underline{\hspace{2cm}}$

These numbers are close together. Start on 7 and hop up to 9. How many hops?

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
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5. $7 - 5 = \underline{\hspace{2cm}}$

Hop back on the path. Circle the square you land on.

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
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6. $9 - \underline{\quad} = 4$

Start on 9. Hop back until you land on 4. How many hops did you take? Write that number in the box above.

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
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Answer: _____

7. $10 - 6 = \underline{\quad}$

Start on 6 and hop up to 10. Count your hops.

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
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8. Eight frogs sat on a log. Five frogs hopped away. How many frogs are still on the log? Show it on the path: start on 8 and hop back 5.

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
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Answer: _____

9. _____ $- 3 = 5$

You do not know where to start! Begin on 5 and hop *up* 3 squares. The square you land on is the missing start number.

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
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Answer: _____

10. Mia had ten stickers. She gave eight stickers away. How many stickers does Mia have now?

Counting back 8 times is a lot of hops. Start on 8 and hop up to 10 instead. Write how many hops you took.

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
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Answer: _____